mixture were dribbled into a starch-iodide solution resting on an illuminated, milk-white sheet of glass. At a certain point in the enzyme reaction, enough quinone was produced from the catechol to turn the iodide into iodine, which reacts with the starch to form a black addition-compound. The first trace of a black fog against the illuminated background as a drop falls into the solution marks the end point.

The time between the start of the enzyme reaction and the end point is measured with a stopwatch. The important part of the research then lay in analyzing the time measurements and trying to builda picture of the enzyme-catechol interrelationships that would account for them.

I would stand there running test after test with my stopwatch in hand, making use of all sorts of different conditions and recording the time in every case. I once ran as many as 32 chronometrics in a single session, but I was told that Lloyd Roth could run 50 or 60. A fellow researcher, Frank Mallette, 4 claimed he had once done 120 in one day. How all this was possible, I couldn't imagine, but considering that I was my undeft self, I considered 32 sufficient.

One thing I found was that I could not duplicate the results of anyone before me. Thinking about it, I decided that it took time for the enzyme to mix with the catechol, so that the reaction didn't proceed at top speed from the beginning. I tried stirring the solution faster and faster, and sure enough, my results differed less from the ideal the faster I stirred. I therefore introduced a "mixing time" constant into the equation and everything worked perfectly. How the devil the preceding investigators had managed to get ideal results without taking mixing into account I was never able to figure out.

2 7 For three months, ever since I had sold "Now You See It—," I had been limping along with a story called "No Connection." This story

4 It was Mallette who had been an assistant in the food analysis laboratory and who had, under instructions, given me difficult unknowns to "get rid" of me. I heard the story from him at about this time.

began as a result of a conversation Campbell and I had gotten into over my story "The Hunted." After Thrilling Wonder had rejected that story, I tried it on Campbell, who shook his head, and in the conversation that followed, free association seemed to give rise to the notion of a co-operative society of intelligent bears threatened by an aggressive society of intelligent chimpanzees.

I wasn't too enamored of the idea so that it went slowly, but I was determined